

1.9 Use of sampling in the 1971 Census

In recent years sampling methods have found increasing application in population censuses in many countries. Experience has shown that most of the demographic data needed could be collected from a carefully selected sample population at considerable saving of time and money. Topics which are suitable for enumeration on a sample basis are those for which accuracy is not absolutely essential, and those for which tabulations are not required for very small administrative units of the country.

The lists of topics enumerated on a complete basis and on a sample basis at the 1971 Census are shown in Section 1.6.

TABLE 1.2 : INFORMATION ON HOUSING OBTAINED AT
THE CENSUSES IN SRI LANKA : 1946 - 1971

	1946	(1) 1953	(2) 1963	1971
Whether housing unit or other living quarters	-	-	-	x
Whether used for residence only or for business too	-	-	x	x
Whether occupied or vacant	-	-	x	x
Type of structure (house, flat etc.)	-	-	-	x
Material of walls	x	x	x	x
Material of roof	x	x	x	x
Material of floor	-	-	x	x
Year of construction	-	-	-	x
Water supply	-	-	x	x
Bathing facilities	-	-	-	x
Toilet facilities	-	-	x ⁽³⁾	x
Type of lighting	-	-	x	x
Number of rooms	x	x	x	x
Floor space	-	-	x	x
Availability of kitchen	-	-	x	x
Fuel used for cooking	-	-	x	-
Tenure (whether rented or owned)	x	x	x	x
If owned and mortgaged, rate of mortgagee	x	-	-	-
Rent	-	x	x	x
Number of families in household/households occupying unit	-	x	x	x
Number of persons in households occupying unit	x	x	x	x
Length of residence in present dwelling	-	x	-	-

Note:

- (1) At the 1953 Census the enumeration was done on a "Household Schedule" in which the particulars were obtained regarding the dwelling or portion of a dwelling occupied by the household.
- (2) The enumeration covered only private housing units i.e. excluding institutions, boarding houses, hotels etc.
- (3) The question "Is the housing unit provided with electricity?" was introduced in 1963.

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